title: “AI at the Knowledge Gates: Institutional Policies and Hybrid Configurations in Universities and Publishers”
authors:
- “Rughiniș, Cosima, et al”
year: “2025”
domain: “AI and Social”
subdomain: “Governance, Leadership and Policy”
tensions:
- “Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity”
- “Operational Assistance vs Epistemic Authority”
concepts:
- “transparency”
- “explainability”
- “governance”
- “knowledge production”
- “AI governance”
- “training data”
methodologies:
- “qualitative”
- “computational”
- “framework development”
stakeholders:
- “researchers”
- “institutions”
- “publishers”
- “policymakers”
- “developers”
source: “Frontiers in Computer Science 7: 1608276”
url: “https://doi.org/10.3389/fcomp.2025.1608276”
status: “reviewed”
type: “annotation”
created: “2026-05-14”
tags:
- cited-in-introduction
- annotation
- ai-and-social
- governance-leadership-and-policy
- method-qualitative
- method-computational
- method-framework-development
- topic-transparency
- topic-explainability
- topic-governance
- topic-knowledge-production
- topic-ai-governance
- topic-training-data
- stakeholder-researchers
- stakeholder-institutions
- stakeholder-publishers

- stakeholder-policymakers
- stakeholder-developers
- tension-technical-capability-v-organizational-capacity
- tension-operational-assistance-v-epistemic-authority

AI at the Knowledge Gates: Institutional Policies and Hybrid Configurations in Universities and Publishers

Rughiniș, Cosima, et al (2025)

Frontiers in Computer Science 7: 1608276

🔗 https://doi.org/10.3389/fcomp.2025.1608276 (https://doi.org/10.3389/fcomp.2025.1608276)

Annotation

This article constitutes a qualitative analysis (i.e., a form of computational analysis) of 16 universities and 12 publishers that attempts to understand how these institutions regulate AI in knowledge production. Rughinis et al. claim that most institutions preserve their values while regulating AI by adapting the regulations they already have in place, stating “institutional policies are shaped by value-based compromises and not by technical concerns alone”. At the same time, although the article acknowledges its focus on institutional regulation, it also admits that “AI adoption can evolve both through policy frameworks and… locally embedded practices that remain partly invisible in formal documentation”. The authors propose two concepts, “dual black-boxing” and “legitimacy-dependent hybrid actors”. Dual black-boxing refers to the lack of transparency in both the “hidden algorithmic processes [and] invisible training data” that shape AI systems and “the opacity surrounding how academics employ AI in their work,” while legitimacy-dependent hybrid actors are “configurations of human-AI ation whose institutional legitimacy is not intrinsic but conditional”. Rughinis et al. argue that transparency is a core academic value, and scholars must work to open these black boxes; they also suggest that that transparency is more closely linked to academic legitimacy in AI-related issues rather than the more traditional issue of the origin of ideas. The majority of the article applies these terms to understanding the regulatory frameworks of universities and publishers, and concludes with the understanding that the majority of institutions allow some form of AI use within certain parameters. The key types of hybrid actors allowed by universities were AI-assisted researchers, AI-enabled translators, AI-enhanced writers, and AI-supported coders, while publishers facilitated the use of AI to refine language, support research methodologies, and aid in research. Ultimately, the authors observe that institutions are permitting AI-supported work in refined roles and argue that AI-based academic work gains legitimacy through transparency.

📖 Appears in Introduction

This annotation is cited in the following sections of the analytical introduction:

- [[Analytical Introduction]] — Research-Related Infrastructures

Navigate to [[Analytical Introduction]] for the complete overview.

Connections

Domain: [[AI and Social]] → Governance, Leadership and Policy

Tensions: [[Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity]] · [[Operational Assistance vs Epistemic Authority]]

Key Concepts: [[Transparency]] · [[Explainability]] · [[Governance]] · [[Knowledge Production]] · [[Ai Governance]] · [[Training Data]]

Methodologies: `qualitative`, `computational`, `framework development`

Stakeholders: researchers, institutions, publishers, policymakers, developers

See Also

- [[Ter-Minassian 2025 - Democratizing-AI-Governance-Balancing-E]] — shared concepts: AI governance, governance, transparency | shared tension: Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity, Operational Assistance vs Epistemic Authority | same subdomain
- [[Gasser 2017 - A-Layered-Model-for-AI-Governance]] — shared concepts: explainability, AI governance, governance, transparency | shared tension: Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity | same subdomain
- [[Cheong 2024 - ative-Approaches-to-AI-Governance-Explo]] — shared concepts: AI governance, governance | shared tension: Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity, Operational Assistance vs Epistemic Authority | same subdomain
- [[Gorwa 2020 - Algorithmic-Content-Moderation-Technica]] — shared concepts: AI governance, governance, transparency | shared tension: Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity, Operational Assistance vs Epistemic Authority | shared methodology: computational
- [[Ngulube 2024 - Integrating-Artificial-Intelligence-Base]] — shared concepts: AI governance, governance, transparency | shared tension: Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity | shared methodology: computational, framework development, qualitative
- [[Birkstedt 2023 - AI-Governance-Themes-Knowledge-Gaps-an]] — shared concepts: AI governance, governance, transparency | shared tension: Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity | same subdomain
- [[Risam 2018 - What-Passes-for-Human-Undermining-the]] — shared concepts: explainability, transparency | shared tension: Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity, Operational Assistance vs Epistemic Authority | shared methodology: computational, framework development
- [[Kirschenbaum 2025 - The-US-of-AI]] — shared concepts: training data, governance | shared tension: Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity, Operational Assistance vs Epistemic Authority | same subdomain

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